



GOVERNANCE

GOVERNANCE IN INDIA

MODULE - 1

GOVERNANCE

"Governance is the exercise of economic, political and administrative authority to manage a country's affairs at all levels. It comprises the mechanisms, processes and institutions through which citizens and groups articulate their interests, exercise their legal rights, meet their obligations and mediate their differences".



CONCEPT OF GOVERNANCE

1 The concept of Governance refers to the **processes** and **structures** that are intended to bring about **accountability, responsiveness, transparency, stability, rule of law, equity and inclusiveness, empowerment and broad-based participation.**

2 Apart from this, Governance also represents the **values, norms and rules** of the system through which **public affairs are managed** in a transparent, responsive, inclusive and participatory way.

3 In a broad sense, Governance can be defined as the **institutional environment** in which **citizens** and other stakeholders **interact** among themselves and **participate** in **public affairs**. Therefore, governance is more significant than **just the organs of government.**



THE FOLLOWING IS THE KEY DISTINCTION BETWEEN GOVERNMENT AND GOVERNANCE

S. NO.	GOVERNMENT	GOVERNANCE
1	Government is the structure which enables and facilitates the process of governance	Governance is the process whereby various actors work for the welfare of the people.
2	It is the machinery and an organ which wields power of the State, it includes the Executive, legislature and the judiciary	It is carried out by various entities including the State and other institutions existing outside of it, which includes the Civil Society, Non-Governmental Organisations
3	It is a formal setup, which interacts within itself and outside of it.	Though it evolves out of the formal setup of the State, it expands the scope of government and also intensifies the service delivery provided.

THE FOLLOWING IS THE KEY DISTINCTION BETWEEN GOVERNMENT AND GOVERNANCE

- 1 There are various entities which are involved in governance.
- 2 Apart from the formal government and its institutions, the other actors are the NGOs, civil society, research institutes, financial institutions, educational institutions, lobbyists, MNCs, media, cooperatives, etc.
- 3 All these institutions play a vital role in decision making and also influence the process of decision making.

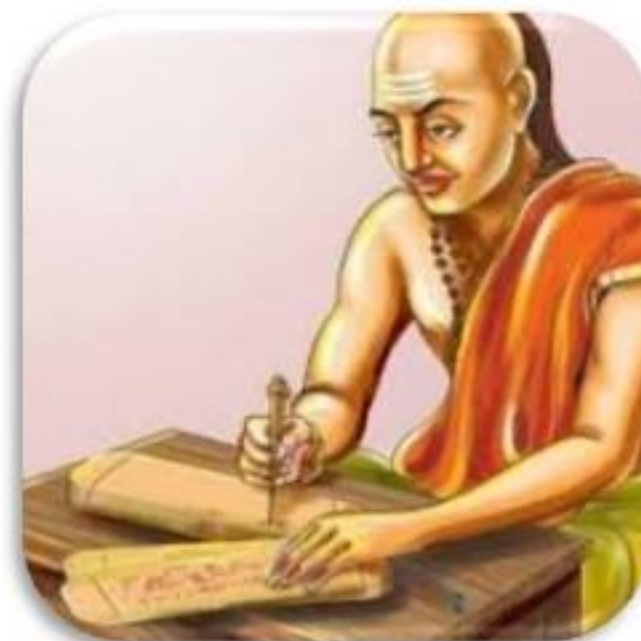


KAUTILYA ON GOOD GOVERNANCE

1 Kautilya also known as Chanakya, in his Arthashastra elaborating on the traits possessed by the king of a welfare state, he stated that the happiness of the king lies with the happiness of his subjects, their welfare is his welfare should not act for his own pleasure but for the pleasure of his subjects.

2 Thus, "The King" is just a title given to the one who governs, this titular role is thought to be the brain of the government and the people, who are governed are considered to be the heart of the government.

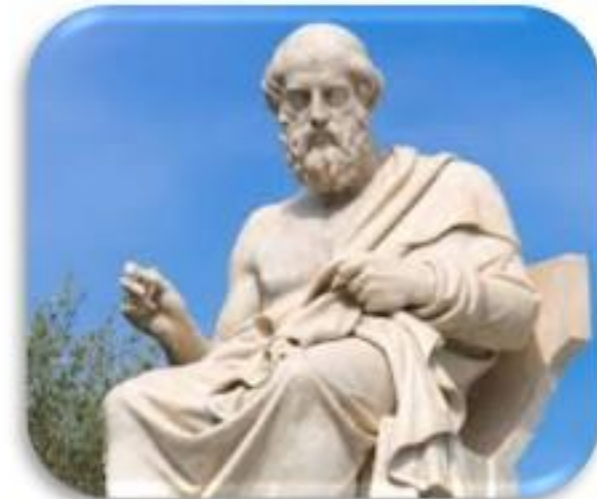
3 The ultimate role of the king is, therefore to govern for the welfare of his people.



PLATO ON GOOD GOVERNANCE

- 1 Plato is credited with creating the Philosopher Kings an Ideal ruler.
- 2 Plato believes that conflicting values of various part of the society can be harmonized.
- 3 The rational and righteous political order as suggested by Plato leads to harmonious unity of society where every part flourishes, without the expense of the other.

- 4 Such a political realization is not possible without virtue. Plato in his book Republic calls for the rule of a Philosopher King

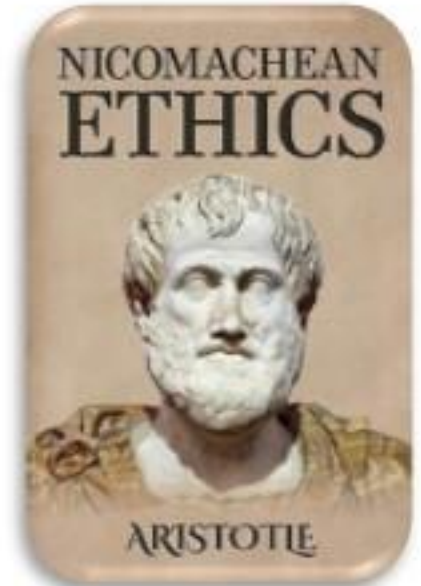


ARISTOTLE ON GOOD GOVERNANCE

1 Aristotle can be considered to be the first person to deal with the term 'governance' when he classified political organization based on the manner they are ruled as Dictatorship, Autocracy and finally Democracy.

2 In his book Nicomachean Ethics, Aristotle describes that only when man lives with virtue, he can live a happy life as intended by nature.

3 In his other book Politics, he describes the role to be played by politicians and the political community in bringing about the life of virtue in the citizenry.



ORIGIN OF THE MODERN CONCEPT OF GOOD GOVERNANCE

- 1 The concept of 'good' governance emanated from the understanding of the process of governance.
- 2 Governance entailed participation from all sections of the society and the concept of good governance emerged at the end of 1980s, an era of tumultuous global political scenario.
- 3 The collapse of Berlin wall on November 1989 triggered a chain of events which ultimately led to the disintegration and collapse of Soviet Union and as a consequence the decay of alliances in the eastern bloc.



ORIGIN OF THE MODERN CONCEPT OF GOOD GOVERNANCE

- 4 These political changes brought about the serious discussion on how a state has to be devised in order to achieve- economic development, or in other words a discussion on good governance.
- 5 In the 1989 World Bank Study Sub-Saharan Africa from Crisis to Sustainable Growth" scrutinized the development problems in sub-Saharan Africa.
- 6 For the first time, the term "governance" was used to define the need for greater institutional reform and a better and more efficient public sector in these countries.
- 7 Because of its use by the World Bank and other International institutions, the concept of good governance gained impetus and is now at present widely welcomed and implemented in countries across the globe.



WORLD BANK

ELEMENTS OF GOOD GOVERNANCE

1 Good governance is a **universally acclaimed**, dynamic concept which is mainly associated with the **effectiveness** and **efficiency** of the administrative system in a governmental framework.

2 The good governance is distinguished by the following aspects:





8 PRINCIPLES OF GOOD GOVERNANCE BY UNITED NATIONS

1. PARTICIPATION

- People should be able to voice their own opinions through legitimate immediate organizations or representatives.
- This includes men and women, vulnerable sections of society, backward classes, minorities, etc.
- Participation also implies freedom of association and expression



2. RULE OF LAW

- Legal framework should be enforced impartially, especially on human rights laws.
- Without rule of law, politics will follow the principle of matsya nyaya ie law of fish which means the strong will prevail over the weak.



8 PRINCIPLES OF GOOD GOVERNANCE BY UNITED NATIONS

3. CONSENSUS ORIENTED

- Consensus oriented decision-making ensures that even if everyone does not achieve what they want to the fullest, a common minimum can be achieved by everyone which will not be detrimental to anyone.
- It mediates differing interests to meet the broad consensus on the best interests of a community.



4. EQUITY AND INCLUSIVENESS

- Good governance assures an equitable society.
- People should have opportunities to improve or maintain their well-being.



8 PRINCIPLES OF GOOD GOVERNANCE BY UNITED NATIONS

5. EFFECTIVENESS AND EFFICIENCY

- Processes and institutions should be able to **produce** results that meet the needs of their community.
- Resources of the community should be **used effectively** for the **maximum output**.



6. ACCOUNTABILITY

- Good governance aims towards **betterment of people**, and this cannot take place without the government being accountable to the people.
- Governmental institutions**, private sectors, and civil society organizations should be held **accountable** to the public and institutional stakeholders.



8 PRINCIPLES OF GOOD GOVERNANCE BY UNITED NATIONS

7. TRANSPARENCY

- Information should be accessible to the public and should be understandable and monitored.
- It also means free media and access of information to them.



8. RESPONSIVENESS

Institutions and processes should serve all stakeholders in a reasonable period of time.



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